AWSAJ ACADEMY

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT

Meeting focus: see what is taught, find gaps, and examine how learning grows

LEADER DIRECTIONS

WHY ARE WE MEETING?

To build an honest K-12 picture of what students actually learn, where essential skills may be missed or unnecessarily repeated, and how learning should progress toward success on the mainstream pathway. It is also our evidence for CIS accreditation (Domain C, The Curriculum): a curriculum that is coherent from grade to grade. **Our mindset: examine the curriculum, not individual teachers. This is for information only: it does not evaluate your teaching, and there is no right answer.**

GUIDING K-12 QUESTION

If a student begins at Awsaj in Kindergarten, what must they learn at each grade to be ready for Grade 12 and the mainstream pathway?

TODAY'S SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE Completed standards ratings + identified must-know skills, potential gaps or repetition, progression concerns, and burning questions for follow-up.

TEAM ROLES AND PREPARATION

FACILITATOR / TIMEKEEPER Lead discussion and pacing; model the worked example below.	**RECORDER** Capture observations, questions, and who should respond.
GRADE / SUBJECT REPS AND ACTIVE PARTICIPANTS Share real teaching practice; listen, question, collaborate.	**ADMINISTRATION** Support attendance, engagement, collaboration, and oversight.

BRING: Laptop, notebook or notepad, pen or pencil, an open mind and a great attitude.

STEP 1 RATE WHAT WAS ACTUALLY TAUGHT

Using last school year as evidence. Do not rate from a pacing guide alone.

ONLINE TOOL: sites.google.com/edi.qfschools.qa/ma3loomat/k-12-vertical-alignment. Choose your team (grade, subject or course). Rate each Common Core (CCSS) standard and Essential Element (EE), or your subject's standards.

First, the leader runs the ▶ Walk-Through Example (top of the team page) with everyone. Practice only, nothing is saved: **1** your standards, **2** the standards for the whole school, **3** how to rate, then each part of the rating page, zoomed in. Then each team opens its own team.

NOT TAUGHT	Our grade does not teach this standard.
INTRODUCED / EXPOSED	Our grade covers it briefly. It is not a main focus and is not assessed on its own.
TAUGHT IN DEPTH	Our grade teaches it directly, students practise it over several lessons, and it is assessed.

Answer for your whole grade level, not only your own class: the level of teaching exposure the majority of your grade's students get. It is about the teaching, not how well students learn or perform. For information only: it does not evaluate your teaching, and there is no right answer.

WORKED EXAMPLE: THE LEADER MODELS ONE, THEN THE GROUP RATES ONE

Ask aloud for every standard:

1. What does it ask students to do?
2. Does our grade teach it? No = **Not taught**.
3. Only briefly, not a main focus or assessed? = **Introduced / exposed**.
4. Taught directly, practised, assessed? = **Taught in depth**.

Then the group rates the first standard on its own page: read it aloud, agree, press the answer.

Example (Grade 3 Math, ★ Power standard):

M.3.NF.A.1 *(CCSS 3.NF.A.1)* Understand a unit fraction as the quantity formed when a whole is partitioned into equal parts (e.g., 1/4). Understand fractions are composed of unit fractions.

> *"Most of our Grade 3 students get three weeks of teaching on it, students practise daily, and it is on the unit test: Taught in depth. Only in one measuring task: Introduced / exposed."*

Other subjects: use the first ★ standard on your page.

Tips: rate only your own grade's standards, for most classes. Click the chosen answer again to take it off. Answers save at once; **Finish** lists anything not answered.

STEP 2 REFLECT INDIVIDUALLY BEFORE DISCUSSING

1. What knowledge or essential skills are students missing when they arrive in your grade?

2. What essential prerequisite skills do students need when they enter your grade?

3. What essential skills should students demonstrate before moving to the next grade?

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K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT

Team discussion · K-12 patterns · evidence to bring forward

LEADER DIRECTIONS

STEP 3 DISCUSS: WHAT ARE WE NOTICING?

Use the completed ratings and your reflections. The recorder should capture specific grades, standards and examples, not assumptions.

1. Which skills are taught in depth, only introduced, or not taught across grades?
2. What prerequisites do students seem to lack when they enter the next grade?
3. Where is learning repeated without greater complexity or independence?
4. How should Common Core standards and Essential Elements progress across K-12?

STEPS 4-6 LOOK ACROSS THE K-12 LEARNING JOURNEY

MUST-KNOW LEARNING

Name the essential skills students must carry into the next grade.

REFLECT: If this skill is missing, what becomes difficult later?

GAPS

Compare what the previous grade teaches with what the next grade expects. Check standards no grade has answered yet.

REFLECT: Where might prerequisite learning be missing?

UNNECESSARY REPETITION

Distinguish purposeful review from repeating the same tasks or difficulty.

REFLECT: Is learning becoming deeper and more independent?

PROGRESSION

Trace skills across grades and discuss increasing accuracy, reasoning, application, and independence.

REFLECT: What should this learning look like next year?

TOOL VIEWS: Coverage map = rated learning by grade and strand · Gaps & repetition = possible missing or duplicated skills · Progressions = how learning builds across grades · Grade dashboard = one grade, every subject. Choose **All subjects** in the Subject box to see every subject at once. A gap is only **confirmed** once every grade that could teach it has rated it.

RECORD TODAY'S KEY FINDINGS

Identify up to three high-priority observations. Record a specific grade or standard to verify.

PRIORITY SKILL / PATTERN	GRADE(S) AND STANDARD(S)	EVIDENCE / NEXT CHECK

BURNING QUESTIONS / CONCERNS

QUESTION OR CONCERN	ADDRESS TO (ADMIN / LEAD / COMMITTEE)

LEADER CHECKLIST

- ☐ Open the tool on the projector before the meeting
- ☐ Share why: honest picture, CIS, not an evaluation
- ☐ Run the Walk-Through Example with everyone
- ☐ Read the three rating levels aloud
- ☐ Model the worked example, then rate one together
- ☐ Show how to change or take off an answer
- ☐ Agree who finishes the ratings, and by when
- ☐ Check progress; remind the team to press Finish

NEXT MEETING 1. Agree on grade and subject-level expectations → 2. Define assessment evidence → 3. Share effective resources